it’s a matric dance. It’s quite a big occasion. I might as well try to get to know her.’

So I did. After a drink and a few words, she came upstairs with me to my room and gave a little dance of another kind. She then left and went back to the dance proper.

In the lead-up to the last Test in Adelaide, one of my fellow single lads and I met these two really cool girls in a bar and had a great time with them. We sort of stuck with them for a while, and on the last night of the tour we had something special in mind. These girls were well connected and we said to them, ‘Listen, you organise as many girlfriends as you can – we’re going to have a huge party back at the hotel.’ We must have had about 30 girls at the party that night – I told you those two were well connected. So: 30 beautiful girls, a few very enthusiastic South African cricketers (only the single ones, of course), an open bar at the Hilton, and the knowledge that we were only leaving the hotel at 5 p.m. the next afternoon. It was one fat party. From mid-evening to the next afternoon, I enjoyed the company of … let’s just say, more than one woman.

That was probably the most eventful night I have ever had. From a work-flow point of view, it wasn’t as difficult as you might expect either. These girls were really up for it and, to be honest, I don’t know if they knew what was going on or not, but no one seemed to mind. You picked a girl up, took her upstairs to your room, and afterwards both of you would go back downstairs and you’d go and chat to someone else. It was a phenomenal night.

And that was just during the Tests.

We also played a triangular ODI series against Australia and New Zealand. It was the first match of the best-of-three final against the Aussies at the Melbourne Cricket Ground. I was made twelfth man again for the finals. I wore number 13, which turned out to be an unlucky number for me on the pitch, but particularly fortuitous off it. We won the first game (lost the series 1-2, though), but any feelings of frustration I might have had because I wasn’t playing quickly dissipated when this girl stopped me in the hotel lobby and asked me if I was ‘Number 13’.

She had two friends with her and apparently they had been waiting for me. To this day I’m not entirely sure why, but, hey, you tend not to question people’s motives when you are presented with such an opportunity. The girls basically invited themselves up to my room. The hotel had pretty big